the government machinery. The BJP launched a big campaign centred on this in each district and vidhan sabha constituency of UP. This was done with the 'sangathan and government working on this in coordination', said Deputy Chief Minister K.P. Maurya. This involved a whole host of the party's senior-most state leaders, its MPs and MLAs, being tasked with visiting specific constituencies to hold public meetings with labharthees. Not only were they asked to visit villages as part of a planned campaign, they each had to spend the night there too, to get a better sense of the mood and what was really happening. 'We used to mostly plan to spend the night in villages,' said Maurya. 'Whether it was the CM, deputy CM, state president, district president or any other office bearer, everyone used to spend a night pravas in some village or the other. The aim was that for those who benefited—whether with gas cylinders under Ujjwala, or houses under PMAY—we would go and assess at every level if there was any wrongdoing. We designed these visits to check if anyone who was supposed to get benefits didn't get them, to see who was left out. If there were weaknesses, we focused on fixing them so that those who needed benefits got them.'[25]

The BJP's booth-level presidents and booth-committee members were central to this drive. Maurya cites the example of ration cards as a case in point. 'BPL [Below Poverty Line] cards were made in 2002. When we went to the people between the 2017 and 2019 elections, it had already been seventeen years since they were made and that is a long time. There were many who had reached the sky from the ground in this time but still had BPL cards. In these visits, we did a deep analysis of this and focused on getting BPL cards for those who really deserved them so that they could get their rights, get toilets, gas connections, health services and food.' The BJP's booth-level workers specifically worked with government beneficiary lists to organise these meetings. When I asked an official in the CMO about the level of coordination between the party and the government on how these government lists of labharthees were used for political mobilisation, the answer was clear. 'When it is a party programme, the party does it; when it is a government programme, the government does it,' said the senior official. 'There is a list in each area on how many people got houses; there is a list